its first three notes in inverse movement in bar 26 (treble) and is incomplete in bars 29 to 31 (bass).

Middle Section.—The middle section commences in bar 31, with a second episode, which is founded on the third bar of the subject in the upper parts, with a free bass. The appearances of the subject in this section are in stretto, and are very orderly. Bars 36 to 44 are in D minor, the stretto in the octave at two bars' distance, all the voices participating, beginning with the highest; bars 46 to 54 in G minor, the stretto at the same interval of pitch and of time, but beginning with the **lowest** voice. To each stretto is added a codetta of two bars ending with a perfect cadence. The third episode (bars 56 to 64) is built on similar material to the second, but quite differently treated.

Final Section.—The final entries are slightly irregular. At the last semiquaver of bar 64 the subject enters in the treble, with its first note shortened and the following bar ornamented. A bar later the subject appears in the alto, making the closest stretto which the fugue contains, but its form also is varied, and it is abandoned at bar 68. On account of the stretti, neither the middle nor the final section employs the countersubject.

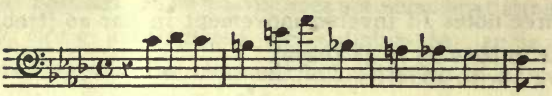
FUGUE 12

F MINOR (FOUR VOICES).

A remarkably fine fugue, rivalling No. 3 in the richness and variety of its episodes. It contains no stretto.

Exposition.—The subject

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 33-35.
BWV 857. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan



is announced in the tenor, and is given a **tonal** answer in the alto (bar 4), in order that the initial dominant may be replied to by the tonic; but it is noteworthy that this tonal form of answer is not heard again throughout the fugue. There is a regular countersubject, commencing on the second quaver of bar 4 and reaching to bar 7, first quaver; this accompanies every subsequent entry except that in bars 40 to 43, and even here the alto and bass give fragmentary suggestions of it. The bass enters with the subject in bar 7, and the tenor has a new counterpoint, which is so frequently used with the subject and countersubject (see bars 13 to 16, 19 to 22, 28 to 30, etc.) as almost to rank as a second countersubject; the three are worked in a triple counterpoint. A codetta of three bars (bars 10 to 12), derived from the countersubject, precedes the entry of the fourth voice, the treble, to which is exceptionally assigned the subject instead of the answer.

Counter-Exposition.—As the next two entries (bar 19, tenor, and bar 27, bass) are still in the original keys, and with the answer leading, it is possible to regard them as constituting a partial and irregular counter-exposition, though they are separated by an episode.

Middle Section.—Unless the above-named two entries be included, this only commences at bar 30. In any case it embraces the subject in A flat major (bar 34) and answer in E flat major (bar 40) and closes at the first beat of bar 47.

Final Section.—This section consists of the answer in C minor (bar 47) and the subject in F minor (bar 53), together with the intervening episode and a three-bar coda.
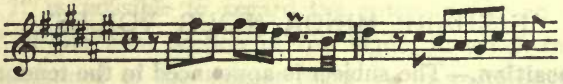
The first episode (bars 16 to 19) is a free inversion of the codetta, treated sequentially. The second (bars 22 to 27) is similar to the first, with inversion of the two upper parts. In the third episode (bars 30 to 34) the first bar of the alto in the codetta is treated sequentially in the bass, imitated by the tenor, with a new counterpoint in the treble. In the fourth (bars 37 to 40) a part of the countersubject (bar 6) is worked sequentially in the treble and made the pattern for some free imitation in the alto, with a florid counterpoint in the bass. Episode 5 (bars 43 to 47) gives a new and more elaborate sequential treatment of the codetta with the addition of a fourth voice; all the other episodes are in three-part harmony. The sixth and last (bars 50 to 53) is a slight modification of the first, transposed into the dominant key.

FUGUE 13

F SHARP MAJOR (THREE VOICES).

This fugue is simple in form, and similar in its construction to Nos. 7 and 9.

Exposition.—The subject is of exactly two bars' length :—



It is given out in the treble and, beginning on the dominant, takes a **tonal** answer (alto, bar 3 to bar 5, first quaver). The countersubject commences with the second note of the answer. After the exposition it is always modified at its beginning and end (bars 15 to 16, 31 to 33) or is quite fragmentary (bar 20, second and third beats) or absent (bars 28 to 30). There is a redundant entry of the subject in bar 11, allowing of the inversion of subject and countersubject.